

London's Hidden Forts & Defences

8 Historic Military Sites · 3 Hours · Thames & City

From Roman walls to Cold War bunkers, London's military history is layered beneath the city streets. Most of these sites are free, hidden in plain sight, and completely unknown to tourists.

YOU SAVE: £110 vs guided tours

■ WHAT THIS GUIDE SAVES YOU

Retail price of this guide
£9.99

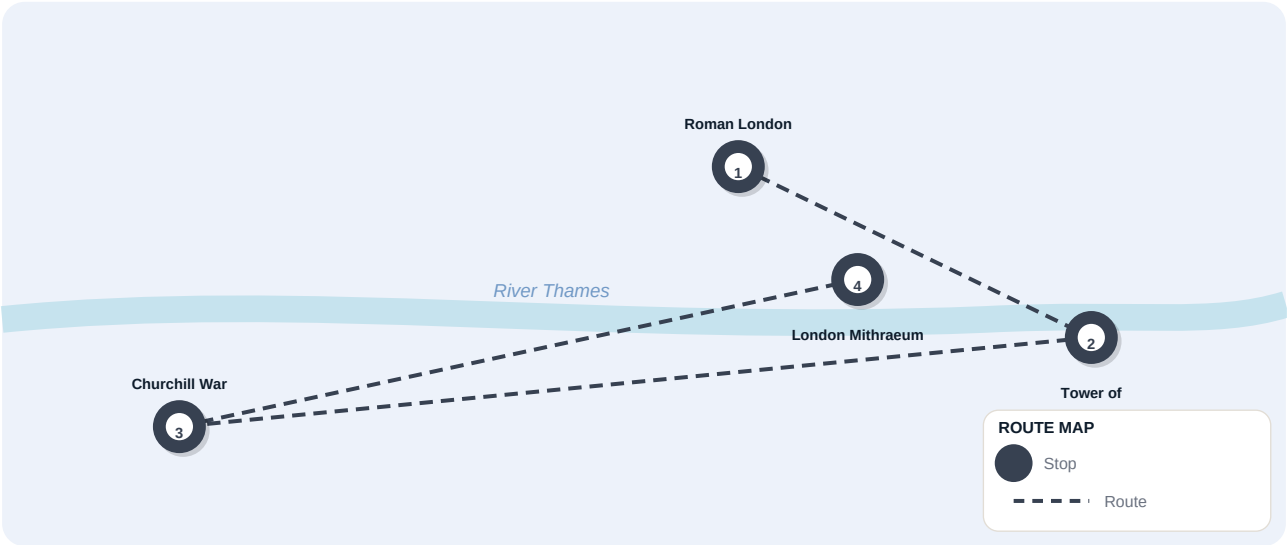
Equivalent guided tours
£120

YOUR SAVING
£110

ROUTE INFO

■ Start	Roman London Wall — Barbican (Barbican/City)
■ End	London Mithraeum — Roman Temple (City of London)
■ Duration	3 Hours
■ Transport	From central London: Zone 1–2 daily cap £8.10 covers all stops
■ Total Cost	Guide: £9.99 · Most stops FREE · See individual stop costs

SCHEMATIC ROUTE MAP



PRO TIPS — READ BEFORE YOU GO

■ Best day	Tuesday–Thursday for fewer crowds at almost every location
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■ Saving	Pre-book anything with tickets — usually £2–4 discount per person
■ Offline map	Download Google Maps offline before leaving your hotel
■ Transport	Use Contactless card — automatic daily cap (Zone 1: £8.10, Zone 1-2: £10.10)
■ Members only	This guide is exclusive to London Lens lifetime subscribers

■ COMPLETE STOP GUIDE — LONDON'S HIDDEN FORTS & DEFENCES

Follow stops 1→4 in order for the best walking route. Each card includes insider tips, savings info, and the cheapest transport option.

1

Roman London Wall — Barbican

Barbican/City · Always open

■ START HERE

HIDDEN TIP

The best-preserved section of the original Roman London Wall (AD 200) stands in a garden next to the Barbican. 15 metres tall in places. Most people walk past without noticing it's 1,800 years old.

■ SAVING

History tours charge £20pp. This is free and better. Saving: £20

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Barbican (3 min walk) or St Paul's (7 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Walk the full remaining section (follow yellow Roman Wall signs) — always open and peaceful
- ✓ Find the medieval tower built on top of the Roman base
- ✓ Touch the original Roman concrete — it's harder than modern cement

■ Best: Any time — always accessible

AVOID:

★★★★★

Free

2

Tower of London Outer Defences

Tower Hill · Always open (outer)

■ 15 min walk

HIDDEN TIP

Walk the outer walls of the Tower for free — the full moat perimeter (now a garden) and all external towers are accessible without a ticket. The outer ward gives you the best views of the medieval military architecture.

■ SAVING

The free outer walk gives 40% of the experience. Saving: £30

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Tower Hill (2 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Walk the full moat perimeter (now a garden)
- ✓ Find the Traitors' Gate from the river path
- ✓ Read the execution accounts on the information boards — free

■ Best: Early morning before the paid crowds

AVOID:

Paying £30 without researching what's free outside first

★★★★■

Free outer

3



Churchill War Rooms

Westminster · Daily 9:30am–6pm (last entry 5pm)

■ 20 min or tube

HIDDEN TIP

The actual underground bunker from which Churchill directed WWII, preserved exactly as it was on 15 August 1945. The Map Room still has the last pins in the exact positions from VE Day. Book online for £2 discount.

■ SAVING

Book online saves £2. Audio guide included. Saving vs tour: £15

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Westminster (5 min walk) or St James's
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Stand in Churchill's actual study where he broadcast
- ✓ The Map Room — last positions from 1945 still in place
- ✓ Churchill Museum attached — included in ticket
- Best: Tue–Thu mornings — quietest

AVOID:

Weekends — book Tuesday or Wednesday for half the crowds

★★★★★

£26 (IWM)

4



London Mithraeum — Roman Temple

City of London · Tue–Sun 10am–6pm

■ 20 min walk

HIDDEN TIP

A fully excavated Roman temple to the god Mithras (AD 240), found when clearing bomb damage in 1954. Now preserved in the basement of Bloomberg HQ. Free timed entry — book online. Sound and light installation is astonishing.

■ SAVING

Completely free. Comparable experience in Rome costs €12. Saving: £10

■ CHEAPEST TRANSPORT

Mansion House (3 min walk)
Cost: Zone 1

DO THIS:

- ✓ Book free timed entry at londonmithraeum.com
- ✓ The sound and light experience recreating Roman ritual
- ✓ See real Roman artefacts found on site
- Best: Any day — book a morning slot

AVOID:

Forgetting to book — they turn you away without a slot

★★★★★

Free (timed entry)

QUICK REFERENCE CARD — CUT OUT OR SCREENSHOT

Summary of all stops for easy on-the-go reference.

#	Name	Area	Walk	Cost	Tube	Rating
1	Roman London Wall — Ba...	Barbican/City	Start here	Free	Barbican (3 min wa	★★★★★
2	Tower of London Outer ...	Tower Hill	15 min walk	Free outer	Tower Hill (2 min	★★★★■
3	Churchill War Rooms	Westminster	20 min or tube	£26 (IWM)	Westminster (5 min	★★★★★
4	London Mithraeum — Rom...	City of London	20 min walk	Free (time	Mansion House (3 m	★★★★★

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